



Part 3

ENVIRONMENT

IDEAS AND VOCABULARY



WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO PROTECT THE NATURAL ENVIRONMENT?

For a couple of reasons, actually. The first thing that comes to my mind is that trees and natural resources provide life for people and animals. For example, without trees, people wouldn't be able to breathe. Moreover, if the water is too polluted because of human actions, then humans wouldn't be able to survive. Because humans need water. So yeah, I think that it is absolutely crucial for people to realize that trees, water, and other natural resources are absolutely crucial and we cannot live without them. For this reason, we should start protecting mother nature as soon as possible.

WHAT DO YOU CONSIDER TO BE THE WORLD'S WORST ENVIRONMENTAL DISASTER CAUSED BY HUMANS?

In my opinion, it's either global warming or a polluted ocean because, well, on the one hand, global warming is very alarming because it's causing a lot of animals and humans to die due to the rising global temperature; on the other hand, I believe that the problem of plastic waste in the ocean is also a very concerning issue caused by humanity because, well, I believe that the problem is irreversible because it's impossible now to start stopping using plastic. All in all, I think that both problems are pretty much irreversible, and I think they caused as much damage.

DO YOU THINK THAT GOVERNMENTS AROUND THE WORLD ARE DOING ENOUGH TO TACKLE THE PROBLEMS?

I definitely don't think so because the environmental issue is very complex. For example, I think that the reason why we still have to depend on polluting fuels, whether it be oil or gas, is because there are individuals or countries that benefit from selling these fuels, and I think that these people will try to do their best to prevent people from being independent of using these polluting fuels because they make a lot of money out of it, so I don't think that developed and developing countries are doing enough to tackle environmental issues if I have to answer your question.

WHAT ARE THE ENVIRONMENTAL PROBLEMS FACED BY COUNTRIES NOWADAYS?

Well, there are a lot of problems right now, but they vary from country to country. For example, I think the most obvious problem in my country is pollution, especially in Bangkok, which is caused by too many cars on the road. I think the government should do more to control the number of cars on the road, whether it be by making public transportation easier to use, or improving public transportation infrastructure, or even, you know, raising taxes on private cars. Another important environmental problem here in Thailand is plastic waste. A lot of people are using plastic bags without thinking about the environmental consequences of this. It not only causes many animals in the sea, like turtles, to die, but it can also obstruct the pipes in the city, and this can cause flooding whenever it rains heavily.